

Word family: **just / justice / justify / justified / justification**

Base word: just

Part of speech: adverb (副詞) / adjective (形容詞)

Related family forms: justice, justify, justified, justification

Useful constructions/extensions: just because, not just...but..., just now, just then, just about, just enough, just in time, just as, just like, just the same, just right, a just decision, just punishment

Your passage contains:

> “I like her **not just because she is family**, but because being around her reminds me that kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

Here, **just** means:

only / merely.

Meaning in this passage

In:

> **not just because she is family**

just means:

only; merely; for that reason alone.

The sentence says:

> you do not like her **only because** she is a relative.

You also like her because of:

- * her kindness;
- * her patience;
- * her strength;
- * what you learn from being around her.

Meaning: Only; merely; no more than that.

繁體中文： ** **只是；僅僅；單單

**中文翻譯： **

> “I like her not just because she is family...”

「我喜歡她，**不只是因為**她是我的家人.....」

So:

not just because = 不只是因為

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. **just = only / merely (只是) — 只是；僅僅**

This is the exact passage meaning.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I like her **not just because** she is family.”

「我喜歡她**不只是因為**她是家人。」

Practice 2

> “I’m **just trying to help**.”

「我**只是想幫忙**。」

Practice 3

> “It was **just a joke**.”

「那**只是一個玩笑**。」

just = 表示事情只限於某個原因、目的、身份或程度，沒有更多含義

2. **not just...but also... (不只是.....而且.....) — 不僅.....還.....**

A major structure and exactly the pattern in your passage.

Practice 4

> “She is **not just kind but also very patient**.”

「她**不只善良，而且非常有耐性**。」

Practice 5

> “The job requires not just experience but also patience.”

「這份工作**不只需要經驗，也需要耐性**。」

not just A but B = 強調 B 是除了 A 以外另一個重要事實

3. **just because (只是因為) — 僅僅因為**

Practice 6

> “You shouldn’t agree **just because** everyone else does.”

「你不應該**只是因為**其他人都同意就跟著同意。」

Practice 7

> “I didn’t choose it just because it was cheap.”

「我不是**單單因為**它便宜才選它。」

just because = 僅僅由於某一個原因

4. **just = exactly (正好；恰好) — 正好；恰恰**

A major separate meaning.

Meaning: Exactly; precisely.

Practice 8

> “That is **just what I needed**.”

「那**正是我需要的**。」

Practice 9

> “You arrived at **just the right time**.”

「你來得**正是時候**。」

****just = 完全準確地符合某個時間、位置、情況或描述****

5. ****just the right...** (恰到好處) — 正合適；剛剛好******

Practice 10

> “The room is ****just the right size****.”

「房間大小****剛剛好****。」

Practice 11

> “This tea is just the right temperature.”

「這杯茶的溫度****恰到好處****。」

****just right = 完全合適，不多不少****

6. ****just like** (正像；就像) — 就像；正如******

Practice 12

> “She looks ****just like**** her mother.”

「她看起來****就像****她媽媽。」

Practice 13

> “The place is just like I remember it.”

「這個地方****和我記得的一模一樣****。」

****just like = 非常 / 完全相似於****

Here ****just**** strengthens the comparison.

7. ****just as** (正如；正當) — 正如；正當.....時******

This construction has more than one use.

Practice 14

> “Do it **just as** I showed you.”

「**完全照我示範的方式**去做。」

Practice 15

> “I arrived **just as** the meeting started.”

「我到達時**正好會議開始**。」

just as = 完全像……那樣；或正好在某件事發生的時候

8. **just** = very recently (剛剛) — 剛剛；才

A major time meaning.

Practice 16

> “I’ve **just finished**.”

「我**剛剛完成**。」

Practice 17

> “She has just arrived.”

「她**剛到**。」

just + perfect tense = 某件事在很短時間之前發生

9. **just now** (剛才) — 剛才；剛剛

Practice 18

> “I saw her **just now**.”

「我**剛才**看見她。」

Practice 19

> “He called me just now.”

「他**剛剛**打電話給我。」

just now = 很短時間之前

Important regional note: in some varieties, **just now** can also mean “very soon,” but for learners the safest core meaning is **剛才** unless context clearly shows otherwise.

10. **just then (就在那時) — 就在那一刻**

Practice 20

> “**Just then**, the phone rang.”

「**就在那時**，電話響了。」

Practice 21

> “Just then, someone opened the door.”

「**就在那一刻**，有人打開了門。」

just then = 正是在所述的那個時刻

11. **just = barely / narrowly (勉強；差一點) — 剛好；勉強**

A major degree meaning.

Practice 22

> “I **just passed** the exam.”

「我**勉強及格**。」

Practice 23

> “We **just caught** the train.”

「我們**剛好趕上**火車。」

****just = 只達到最低程度，或非常接近錯過 / 失敗****

Context determines whether Chinese is:

- * 勉強;
- * 剛好;
- * 差一點就.....

12. ****just enough (剛剛足夠) — 剛好夠****

Practice 24

> “We have ****just enough time****.”

「我們的時間****剛剛好夠****。」

Practice 25

> “There is just enough food for everyone.”

「食物****剛好夠****所有人吃。」

****just enough = 數量 / 程度剛好達到需要，但沒有多餘****

13. ****just in time (及時趕上) — 剛好趕上；及時****

Practice 26

> “We arrived ****just in time****.”

「我們****剛好及時趕到****。」

Practice 27

> “She reached the station just in time for the train.”

「她****剛好趕上****那班火車。」

****just in time = 在最後可接受的時刻之前到達 / 完成****

14. **just about (差不多；幾乎) — 幾乎；差不多**

A common informal expression.

Practice 28

> “I’m **just about ready**.”

「我**差不多準備好了**。」

Practice 29

> “We’ve just about finished.”

「我們**差不多完成了**。」

just about = almost / nearly ; 接近完成或某個程度

15. **just = simply / really, for emphasis (簡直；真的) — 簡直；就是**

A common emphatic use.

Practice 30

> “That’s **just amazing**.”

「那**簡直太驚人了**。」

Practice 31

> “I just love this place.”

「我**真的很喜歡**這個地方。」

just = 用來加強情緒、評價或語氣

Here it does not mean “only.”

16. **I just don’t know (就是不知道) — 實在；真的**

Practice 32

> “I **just** don’t know what to say.”

「我**真的**不知道**該說甚麼**。」

Practice 33

> “I just can’t believe it.”

「我**實在**無法相信**。**」

just = 加強說話者的無奈、驚訝、肯定等情緒

17. **just** = simply for politeness/softening (只是想.....) — 語氣緩和

A pragmatic use.

Practice 34

> “I **just** wanted to ask a question.”

「我**只是想問**一個問題。」

Practice 35

> “I’m just checking whether you received the message.”

「我只是想確認你有沒有收到訊息。」

just = 令請求 / 說法聽起來較柔和、較不強硬

The literal “only” meaning is still present, but the conversational function is important.

18. **just** = immediately / right now in commands (現在就) — 就；馬上

In some imperative expressions, **just** can add directness.

Practice 36

> “**Just** wait here.”

「你**就在這裡等**。」

Practice 37

> “Just listen for a moment.”

「你**先聽一下**。」

just + imperative = 常用來令指示顯得簡單直接，有時也可柔化或加強語氣

Its exact force depends heavily on tone.

19. **just = adjective: fair (公正的) — 公平的；公正的**

A completely separate adjective meaning.

Meaning: Morally fair and based on what is right.

Practice 38

> “We need a **just decision**.”

「我們需要一個**公正的決定**。」

Practice 39

> “Everyone deserves a just system.”

「每個人都應該享有一個**公平公正的制度**。」

just = 符合公平、正義和道德原則的

This is unrelated to the adverb meaning “only.”

20. **just punishment/reward (公正的處罰 / 回報) — 應得而公平**

Practice 40

> “The court must impose a **just punishment**.”

「法院必須作出**公正適當的處罰**。」

Practice 41

> “They wanted a just outcome.”

「他們希望得到一個**公平合理的結果**。」

just = 結果 / 待遇與行為、權利或情況相稱而公平

21. **justice (正義 / 司法) — 正義；公正；司法**

A major related noun.

Practice 42

> “They wanted **justice**.”

「他們希望得到**公義 / 公正對待**。」

Practice 43

> “The justice system should treat people fairly.”

「**司法制度**應公平對待人們。」

justice = 公平、正義的原則；亦可指司法制度及其運作

22. **do justice to (充分呈現 / 公平評價) — 充分表現；不辜負**

A major family idiom.

Practice 44

> “The photo doesn’t **do justice to** the view.”

「這張照片**無法充分呈現**景色真正的美。」

Practice 45

> “A short summary cannot do justice to her life story.”

「簡短摘要**不足以充分呈現**她的人生故事。」

do justice to = 充分、公平地展現某人 / 某物真正的價值、品質或複雜程度

23. **justify (證明.....有道理 / 合理化) — 證明合理 ; 為.....辯解**

A major related verb.

Practice 46

> “Can you **justify your decision**?”

「你能**證明你的決定有合理理由**嗎？」

Practice 47

> “The result does not justify the cost.”

「這個結果不足以**證明那筆成本是值得 / 合理的**。」

justify = 提供足夠理由，證明某行動、決定或信念是合理 / 正當的

24. **justify doing something (為做某事提供正當理由) — 證明有理**

Practice 48

> “Nothing can **justify treating people badly**.”

「沒有任何事情能**合理化惡劣對待別人的行為**。」

Practice 49

> “The risk may justify taking extra precautions.”

「這個風險可能足以**證明採取額外預防措施是合理的**。」

justify doing = 提供足夠理由使某行動被視為合理 / 正當

25. **justified (有充分理由的) — 合理的 ; 有正當理由的**

Practice 50

> “Her concern was completely **justified**.”

「她的擔心是完全**有道理 / 有充分理由的**。」

Practice 51

> “He felt justified in refusing.”

「他認為自己拒絕是**有正當理由的**。」

justified = 有足夠事實 / 理由支持，因此可被認為合理

26. **justification (理由 / 正當依據) — 理由；正當性**

Practice 52

> “There was no **justification** for the delay.”

「延誤沒有任何**合理理由**。」

Practice 53

> “She gave a clear justification for her decision.”

「她清楚說明了自己決定的**理由 / 依據**。」

justification = 用來證明某行動、決定或信念合理的理由 / 論據

27. **justly (公正地) — 公平地；合理地**

A less common but useful family form.

Practice 54

> “He was **justly praised** for his work.”

「他因工作表現而受到**應得的讚賞**。」

Practice 55

> “The decision was justly criticized.”

「這個決定受到批評是**有充分理由的**。」

****justly** = 以公平 / 合理 / 應得的方式

Important distinction: **just = only vs exactly**

Compare:

> “I ****just**** need five minutes.”

= 我****只需要****五分鐘。

versus:

> “That’s ****just**** what I need.”

= 那****正是****我需要的。

Same word, different meaning.

Important distinction: **just = only vs recently**

> “I ****just**** called her.”

This can mean:

> 我****剛剛****打過電話給她。

But:

> “I ****just**** called to ask one question.”

can mean:

> 我****只是****打來問一個問題。

Context and tense are crucial.

Important distinction: **just vs only**

These often overlap.

just

> “I just wanted to help.”

only

> “I only wanted to help.”

Both can mean:

> 我只是想幫忙。

But **just** often sounds more conversational and can soften the statement.

Important distinction: **just vs merely**

just

= everyday and conversational.

merely

= more formal and sometimes dismissive.

> “It was just a suggestion.”

> “It was merely a suggestion.”

Both mean 「只是一個建議」, but **merely** sounds more formal.

Important distinction: **just vs exactly**

just

can mean exactly:

> “That’s just right.”

exactly

is more explicit:

> “That’s exactly right.”

Both can mean:

> 完全正確 / 恰好.

But **just** is more flexible and conversational.

Important distinction: **just now** vs **now**

now

= at the present time.

just now

usually = a very short time ago.

> “I’m busy now.”

= 我現在忙。

> “I saw him just now.”

= 我剛才看見他。

Important distinction: **just in time** vs **on time**

This is essential.

on time

= at the scheduled/planned time.

just in time

= at the last possible moment before being too late.

> “The train arrived on time.”

= 火車準時。

> “I arrived just in time for the train.”

= 我剛好趕上火車。

Important distinction: **just enough** vs **enough**

enough

= sufficient.

just enough

= exactly sufficient, with little or nothing extra.

> “We have enough food.”

= 食物足夠。

> “We have just enough food.”

= 食物剛剛好夠。

Important distinction: **just about** vs **exactly**

just about

= almost / approximately.

exactly

= precisely.

> “I’m just about finished.”

= 我差不多完成。

> “I’m exactly halfway.”

= 我正好完成一半。

Important distinction: ****just right vs almost right****

****just right****

= exactly suitable/correct.

****almost right****

= close, but still not fully correct.

Opposite degree relationship.

Important distinction: ****just like vs like****

****like****

= similar to.

****just like****

= very/exactly similar to.

> “She is like her mother.”

= 她像她媽媽。

> “She is just like her mother.”

= 她簡直 / 完全像她媽媽。

Important distinction: ****just as vs as****

****Just**** often strengthens exactness.

> “Do it as I showed you.”

= 照我示範的方式做。

> “Do it just as I showed you.”

= ****完全照****我示範的方式做。

Important distinction: **just** = emphasis vs **only**

Compare:

> “I just love this song.”

Usually:

= 我真的很喜歡這首歌。

Not:

= 我只喜歡這首歌。

If you mean “only,” context or placement matters:

> “I like just this one.”

= 我只喜歡這一個。

Important distinction: **just because** vs **because**

because

simply gives a reason.

just because

often emphasizes:

> this one reason alone.

> “Don’t do it just because everyone else does.”

= 不要**只是因為**大家都這樣做就跟著做。

Important distinction: **not just A but B**

This structure does **not** mean A is false.

It means:

> A is true, but B is also true and important.

Your passage:

> “not just because she is family, but because...”

still means:

> being family is one reason.

It is simply **not the only reason**.

This is crucial.

Important distinction: **just = fair vs fair**

**just**

= morally/rightfully fair, often slightly formal.

**fair**

= broader everyday word for reasonable, equal, unbiased treatment.

> a just society

sounds moral/philosophical.

> a fair decision

sounds everyday.

They overlap but differ in register.

Important distinction: **just vs right**

**just**

= morally fair.

right

can mean:

- * morally correct;
- * factually correct;
- * suitable;
- * direction opposite left.

So **right** is much broader.

Important distinction: **just vs legal**

Something can be:

> legal but unjust

or:

> illegal but viewed by some as morally justifiable.

So:

legal = 符合法律

just = 符合公平 / 正義

Different concepts.

Important distinction: **justice vs fairness**

fairness

= quality of treating people reasonably/equally.

justice

= broader principle of moral/legal rightness, often involving rights, punishment, remedy, and institutions.

They overlap but **justice** is broader and more formal.

Important distinction: **justify vs explain**

explain

= make the reason/cause clear.

justify

= show that something was reasonable/right.

You can explain a bad decision without justifying it.

This distinction is very important.

Important distinction: **justify vs excuse**

justify

= show an action was actually reasonable/right.

excuse

= reduce blame or provide a reason why wrongdoing should be forgiven.

Not the same.

Important distinction: **justified vs correct**

justified

= supported by sufficient reasons/evidence.

correct

= factually or technically right.

A fear can be:

> justified

without being “correct” in the same grammatical sense.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **just** family is especially rich because the base word has both major adverb and adjective meanings:

- * **just — only/merely** = 只是 / 僅僅
- * **not just...but...** = 不只是.....還.....
- * **just because** = 只是因為
- * **just — exactly** = 正好 / 恰好
- * **just right** = 剛剛好
- * **just like** = 就像 / 完全像
- * **just as** = 正如 / 正當
- * **just — recently** = 剛剛
- * **just now** = 剛才
- * **just then** = 就在那時
- * **just — barely** = 勉強 / 剛好
- * **just enough** = 剛好足夠
- * **just in time** = 剛好趕上
- * **just about** = 幾乎 / 差不多
- * **just — emphasis** = 簡直 / 真的
- * **just — softener** = 只是想..... ; 緩和語氣
- * **just — fair** = 公正的 / 正義的
- * **justice** = 正義 / 公正 / 司法
- * **do justice to** = 充分呈現 / 公平評價
- * **justify** = 證明合理 / 正當化
- * **justified** = 有充分理由的
- * **justification** = 合理理由 / 正當依據
- * **justly** = 公正地 / 應得地

The main semantic branches are:

> **only / merely**

> **exactly / precisely**

> **very recently**

> **barely / narrowly**

> **emphasis and conversational softening**

> **morally fair / righteous**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
just — only/merely	表示事情只限於某個原因、目的、身份或程度；只是 / 僅僅
not just...but...	A 並非唯一情況；除 A 外，B 亦同樣 / 更加重要
just because	僅僅因為某一個原因
just — exactly	完全準確地符合某個時間、位置、情況或描述
just right	程度、大小、時間等完全合適，不多不少
just like	與某人 / 某物非常或完全相似
just as	完全按照某方式；或正好在某事件發生時
just — recently	某件事情在很短時間之前發生
just now	在很短時間之前；剛才
just then	正是在所述的那一刻
just — barely	僅僅達到最低程度，或非常接近錯過 / 失敗
just enough	數量 / 程度正好足夠，但沒有多餘
just in time	在最後可接受的時刻之前到達 / 完成
just about	幾乎 / 差不多達到某狀態
just — emphasis	加強情緒、評價或肯定語氣；真的 / 簡直
just — softener	在請求、說明中令語氣較柔和、較不強硬
just — fair	符合公平、正義和道德原則的
justice	公平正義的原則；亦可指司法制度
do justice to	充分、公平地展現某人 / 某物真正的價值或品質
justify	提供足夠理由證明某事合理 / 正當
justified	有足夠理由 / 證據支持，因此合理
justification	用來證明某行動、決定或信念合理的理由 / 依據
justly	以公平、合理或應得的方式

For your original passage

> “Overall, I like her **not just because she is family**, but because being around her reminds me that kindness can be quiet, steady, and deeply powerful.”

The exact meaning is:

just = only / merely

Therefore:

> **not just because she is family**

= **「不只是因為她是家人」**

The structure is important:

> **not just A, but B**

does **not** reject A.

Being family **is still one reason** you like her.

But the sentence says:

> that reason alone is not enough to explain your feelings.

There is another, deeper reason:

> being around her teaches you something about kindness.

So the logical structure is:

> **A is true**

> +

> **A is not the whole explanation**

> +

> **B adds another important reason**

The most important learner contrasts are:

> **I just want to help.**

> = 我只是想幫忙。

> **not just because... **

> = 不只是因為.....

> **That's just what I need.**

> = 那正是我需要的。

> **It's just right.**

> = 剛剛好。

> **She looks just like her mother.**

> = 她完全像她媽媽。

> **I've just finished.**

> = 我剛剛完成。

> **I saw him just now.**

> = 我剛才看見他。

> **I just passed.**

> = 我勉強及格。

> **just enough time**

> = 剛好足夠的時間

> **just in time**

> = 剛好趕上

> **just about finished**

> = 差不多完成

> **I just love it.**

> = 我真的很喜歡。

> **a just decision**

> = 公正的決定

> **justice**

> = 正義 / 公正

> **justify a decision**

> = 證明某決定合理

> **a justified concern**

> = 有充分理由的擔心

So **just** is one of those words where the Chinese translation changes dramatically according to function:

> **只是**

> **正好**

> **剛剛**

> **勉強**

> **簡直 / 真的**

> **公正的**

And in your original passage it specifically means:

****“only / merely — being family is one reason, but not the only reason she matters to you.”****